



Fire safety in the home

Overview

Fire safety in the home comprises a set of five units; *Fire safety in the home*, *Make your home safe*, *Bedtime safety checks*, *Fire!* and *Fire safety in the home - research and revision*. These units aim to support learners in developing the language, knowledge and understanding to:

- recognise common causes of fires
- make their homes as safe as possible
- know what action to take if there is a fire and use 999 to call for the fire service if necessary.

Level: Each set of resources includes:

- activities for beginner reader writers
- activities at Entry 1 (Access 2 in Scotland)
- differentiated activities for learners at Entry 2/ Entry 3 (Access 3/Intermediate level 1 in Scotland) or higher
- ideas for extension activities

Learning hours and delivery context:

The five *Fire safety in the home* units provide a minimum of 7.5 hours of learning in a classroom context. These units can be used independently or as one linked topic over four or more sessions. If you are going to use more than unit, use them in the order provided. Timings are flexible and teachers can break the units into smaller chunks of learning and build in differentiation, revision and extension activities as required.

The resource is suitable for use in a wide range of adult ESOL learning contexts including community ESOL and FE. Additionally, the teacher notes provide suggestions on how practitioners can develop further linked learning (such as developing and working with learner-produced texts) and build links with the local fire service to further develop and support learners' skills, knowledge and confidence.

Preparation

Fire safety in the home units comprise:

1. Activities and worksheets to download and print. Key words matching sheets can be printed off, laminated and cut up to make matching activities or for learners to play pelmanism. Alternatively learners can draw lines to match the words and pictures. Key words answer sheets can be used to check answers and for beginner readers writers to recognise, read and say each key word then write over the grey version of each word and copy independently on the dotted lines.
2. On-line interactive activities which need a computer with data projector and audio speakers – these can be done independently or in pairs if there are enough computers, or projected onto the screen and done as a whole class activity
3. *Fire safety* leaflets - you can ask learners to view these on line, request copies from your local fire service or download from www.directgov.uk. The main leaflet to support activities in these units is: **Fire – make your home safe** leaflet (Entry 1+):
http://www.direct.gov.uk/prod_consum_dg/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_182673.pdf



For additional reading and research, learners with (Entry 2+/Access 3+) English can read the **Fire safety in the home** leaflet:

http://www.direct.gov.uk/en/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_073993.pdf

Entry 2+/Access 3+ learners who live in shared or rented accommodation, can also read the **Fire safety in shared or rented accommodation** leaflet:
http://www.direct.gov.uk/en/groups/dg_digitalassets/@dg/@en/documents/digitalasset/dg_074034.pdf

You can also:

- collect images or newspaper stories relating to fire safety in the home
- get further information from the website for the fire service in your area, e.g. <http://www.london-fire.gov.uk/SafetyAtHome.asp>
- take a smoke alarm into the class. In some areas it is possible to request one from the local fire service
- contact your local fire service and ask if they are able to visit the centre and meet learners. Local fire services are often keen to have opportunities to meet people from the local community in order to raise awareness about fire safety. In some areas they will have forms for local residents to fill in and return requesting a fire safety visit to their homes and for a free smoke alarm to be fitted. Your local fire service may have a community liaison person who can help to arrange this.

Teacher notes

Unit 1: Fire safety in the home

Time: approximately 1.5 hours

Aims:

- To support learners in developing the language, knowledge and understanding to recognise common causes of fires in homes

Objectives:

By the end of this session, all learners will:

- Learn some key words about fire safety
- Identify some causes of fires in homes

Beginner reader writers will:

- Read and use some key words about fire safety in the home

Entry 2/Access 3 + learners will:

- Read a short simple text (Fire safety leaflet) about common causes of fires in the home
- Say, read and write short simple sentences about common causes of fires in the home

Suggested procedure

1. Set the context (all levels)

Use paper-based or on-line images from Activity 1 Key words to elicit ideas, suggestions and comments about the main topic – common causes of fire in the home. Ask prompt questions such as:

- Have ever had a fire in your home? Or do you know anyone who has?
- If so, what caused the fire?
- What can cause fires in homes?

Explain to learners they are going to about common causes of fires in the home.

2. Fire safety – key words Entry 1/Access 2/beginner reader writers

If you have a data projector:

- Project the images from *Activity 1: Picture matching* on to the whiteboard.
- Point at the images and elicit, model and drill the target vocabulary.
- Focus learners' attention on the key words and elicit what each word says focusing particularly on blended and single initial letter sounds.
- Learners then take it in turns to drag and drop words into the boxes.
- Check answers together as a whole group.

If you don't have a data projector, or as a follow up activity:

- Use realia or enlarged images as flash cards or images projected onto the whiteboard to elicit, model and drill the target vocabulary from the *Activity 1: Key words* worksheet.
- Learners then work individually or in pairs to match the key words and images either using laminated cards or by drawing lines on the *Fire safety – key words* worksheet.
- Monitor and, as necessary, elicit ideas for the answers focusing particularly on blended and single initial letter sounds
- Give out *Activity 1- key words answers*. Ask learners to check their answers individually or in pairs.
- Beginner reader writers can then read and say each word, write over the grey version of each word and then copy some or all of the key words independently on the dotted lines.

3. Fires in the home (all levels)

Task 1: Fire safety 1 – image library game (all levels) if you have a data projector:

- Use the images from Task 1 Picture matching projected onto the whiteboard and/or mime to elicit possible problems and causes of fires in the home.
- Ask learners to name each image using the key words in the 'Choose' and 'Learn' sections from Task 1 Picture matching.
- Learners read aloud and/or listen to and repeat each word from the 'Remember' section statement from the audio and agree which is the correct image to select.

- Learners remember and/or listen to and then write each word correctly.

Task 2: Fire!

If you don't have a data projector, or as a follow up activity:

- Use realia, enlarged images as flash cards and/or mime to elicit possible problems and causes of fires in the home using some of the key words from gap fill exercise, e.g. hot, burning etc.
- Give out *Fires in the home 1*.
- Focus learners' attention on key words at bottom of page. Ask learners to read words aloud and check understanding.
- According to learners' levels they can complete the task in different ways:

Beginner reader writers

- Ask learners to identify the correct image for each word and try to make a statement about the different reasons for fires.
- Choose a few sentences with images enlarge them and cut them into strips.
- Practise reading the sentences with the learners
- Cut each sentence into two. Ask learners to match the sentence halves and then practise reading the sentences aloud.

Learners who can read short simple sentences:

- Learners can work together to choose the correct word to fill the gap in each sentence.

Higher level learners:

- Ask learners to fold the worksheet so they cannot see the missing words and then work together to try and complete each sentence correctly.
- Alternatively you can ask learners to folding the paper on the dotted line before looking at the missing words and learners work individually or in pairs to predict the missing words.
- Give out *Fires in the home (answers key)* or project the answers onto the whiteboard. Ask learners to check their answers individually or in pairs.

- Learners who need practise with the present simple (*is, isn't, are, aren't*) can do *Fires in the home 2* activity and then check against *Fires in the home 1* (*answer key*)

4. Recap and extension activities

- Use realia and/or images to check learning and revise key words.
- Have a whole group discussion about what learners have learned and ask learners to check in their homes for possible fire hazards and report back next lesson.
- Learners can read the leaflet *Fire – make your home safe* and find the pages with content about what has been covered in Unit 1.